Six weeks · finance people and developers · devnet only

DeFi on Solana

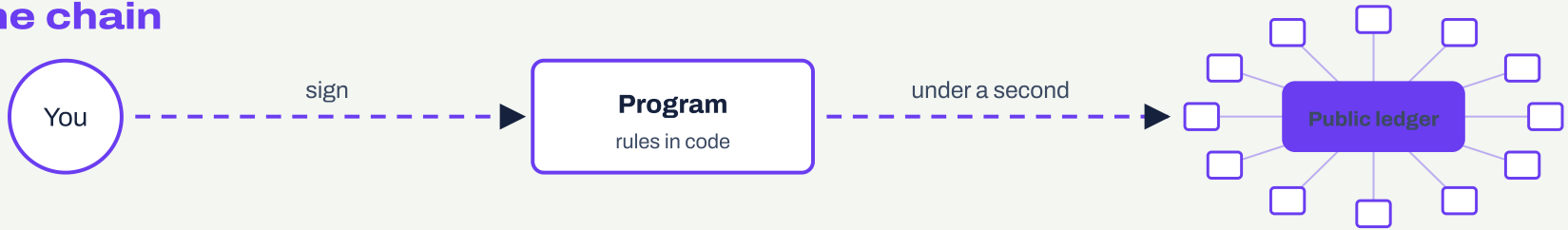
From the bank ledger to the on-chain ledger.

One ledger, two ways to keep it

The bank



The chain



DeFi = financial services written as programs anyone can call.

Six weeks, six entries

Wk	Topic	What you learn	You ship
1	**Intro to DeFi**	Finance as open programs. The Solana map.	**Trace a Jupiter route**
2	**Wallets & devnet**	Keys, accounts, tokens, transactions.	**Send devnet USDC, read it on Orb**
3	**Liquidity & AMMs**	x · y = k, impermanent loss, yield.	**Provide liquidity on devnet**
4	**Lending & stables**	Collateral, health factor, liquidation, oracles.	**Liquidation spreadsheet**
5	**Risk & security**	Hacks grouped by root cause.	**Post-mortem + token audit**
6	**Capstone & careers**	Build, present, get paid for it.	**Demo day**

Every week runs the same loop



Users

Wallets, explorers, dashboards, spreadsheets. **No code needed.**

Builders

Everything users do, **plus a code extension** each week.

If you learned crypto on Ethereum

Click a card to translate it. Keep this open all six weeks.

Solana

Mint account + token accounts

One shared token program. Your balance sits in your own token account.

Solana

Orb, Solscan, explorer.solana.com

Add ?cluster=devnet to the URL to see devnet.

Solana

Devnet

api.devnet.solana.com. Solana "testnet" is for validators, not you.

Solana

Phantom, Solflare, Backpack

All speak the wallet standard, so any Solana app works with any of them.

Solana

USDC, USDT, PYUSD, USDG

Solana money is mostly fiat-backed stablecoins.

Solana

Kamino, Jupiter Lend, Save, Project 0

Same mechanics: collateral, LTV, liquidation.

Solana

Raydium, Orca, Meteora + Jupiter

Most people swap through Jupiter, which routes across all of them.

Solana

Base fee + priority fee + rent

Fractions of a cent. Rent is a refundable deposit for storage.

Solana

Missing account checks

Every account is an input. "Is this the real account?" is the core security question.

Solana

Rust + Anchor + LiteSVM \ Surfpool

Anchor 1.x ships Surfpool as the default test validator.

Solana

Pyth, Switchboard

Pyth is pull: the app fetches a signed price and posts it in the same transaction.

Flip all

Three rules for the whole course

1. **Never share a seed phrase or private key.** Not with support, not with me, not in a screenshot.

2. **Devnet and test tokens only.** The one exception is an optional $5 in week 4, and we will say so loudly.

3. **Numbers carry dates.** TVL, prices and supply change weekly. Say when you looked.

The toolkit

Need	Use
Wallet	Phantom, Solflare or Backpack, set to **Devnet**
Devnet SOL	`faucet.solana.com` or `solana airdrop 2 --url devnet`
Devnet USDC	`faucet.circle.com` · mint `4zMMC9srt5Ri5X14GAgXhaHii3GnPAEERYPJgZJDncDU`
Explorer	Orb (`orb.helius.dev`), Solscan, `explorer.solana.com` + `?cluster=devnet`
Prices	Pyth (`insights.pyth.network`); Builders read the price account on chain
Data	DefiLlama, Artemis, Dune
Builders	Anchor 1.x, LiteSVM, Surfpool, `@solana/kit`

> **Faucets break in class**
> The SOL faucet limits by IP, so one shared Wi-Fi gets throttled. Pre-fund a teacher wallet and send SOL around.

Let’s start.

Week 1: what DeFi is, and why so much of it runs on Solana.

Open week 1